

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

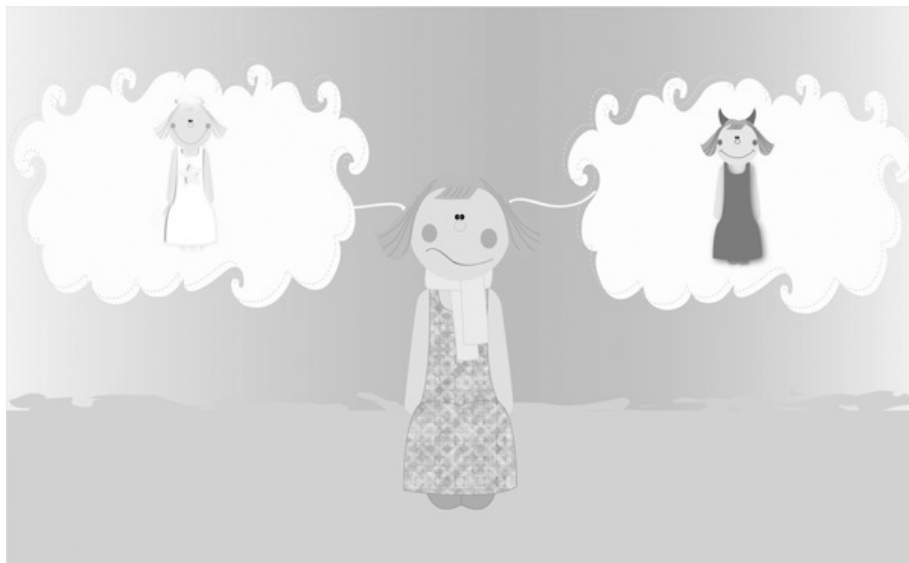
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Sometimes it's hard to know the right thing to do.



Learning Outcome

Express duty, advice, willingness, or intention to do something in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever asked yourself: What is the best thing to do? When?
- How do you solve moral dilemmas?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about social issues, beliefs, opinions and moral or personal dilemmas.
- I can express freedom of choice or prohibition.
- I can express willingness or intention to do something.





Let's Explore!

Listen to **the little voice inside your head***.

* "The little voice inside your head" is your conscience, which you use to distinguish between right and wrong.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

A Clear Conscience

Remember that little voice inside your head telling you that you are thinking about doing wrong? It is the voice saying you mustn't do this, you cannot think that or you may not go there. It's trying to keep you out of danger and protect your place in the social environment. How humans came to develop a conscience has been a subject of debate and research at least since Darwin's Origin of Species was published in 1859. Although our inner consciousness may detect something is up, it can't always point us in the right direction. We will choose our own path according to our personal judgment.

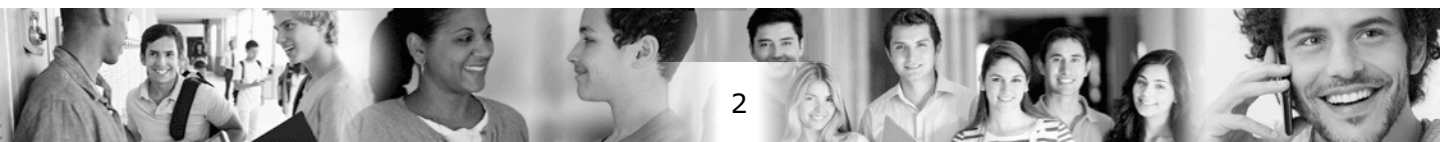
Having an ethical dilemma means that you are not sure whether there is a "right" thing to do in a situation. You are confronted with two imperfect choices, but you will only be able to choose one. How, in this case, do you decide?

One technique to use when thinking about a problem is to approach it through utilitarianism. Utilitarianism maintains that the "right" choice is the one that does the least harm, focusing on "utility" or usefulness to society as a whole. The benefits to many, in this argument, far outweigh the benefits to one. Therefore, utilitarians must use this maxim to make their choice. If you are a utilitarian, you will prioritize the consequences over the actions themselves.

Deontology offers another approach. In deontology, actions are either inherently right or wrong. Individuals must distinguish between them. To do this, an individual follows a set of rules. As a follower of deontology, you assess whether the value of a particular action is less than the consequences of that action.

Utilitarianism and deontology in their purest forms represent the opposite sides of a spectrum. Other theories abound, mixing the two in varying degrees.

We don't have to decide on the "right" theory for every situation, but it is interesting to see what insight each perspective has to offer on the path towards a clear conscience.





Let's Practice!

What weighs on your conscience?

Instructions: Draw a line to match the words in Column A with the definitions in Column B. Write a sentence with each of the words in Column A.

COLUMN A

1. Conscience.
2. Judgment.
3. Imperfect.
4. Utilitarianism.
5. Deontology.
6. Inherently.

COLUMN B

- a. the inner sense of what is right or wrong.
- b. a form of ethics dealing with moral obligation and right action.
- c. existing within or describing something by its nature.
- d. not perfect; faulty in some way.
- e. the ability to judge or make decisions.
- f. an ethical doctrine based on utility.

1. _____.
2. _____.
3. _____.
4. _____.
5. _____.
6. _____.



Let's Practice!

What's right?

Instructions: Use the phrases from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

must distinguish / you mustn't do / don't have to / they must use

1. It is the voice saying _____ this, you cannot think that or you may not go there
2. Utilitarians believe the benefits to many far outweigh the benefits to one, therefore, _____ this maxim to make their choice
3. In deontology, actions are either inherently right or wrong, and individuals _____ between them
4. We _____ decide on the "right" theory for every situation, but it is interesting to see what insight each perspective has to offer





Extension Activity

Think of an ethical dilemma and find different solutions.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, discuss the two ethical doctrines described in this lesson.
- Choose a moral dilemma.
- Give your opinion on the dilemma.
- Using the ethical doctrines, think of at least two different solutions to the moral dilemma.
- Write a paragraph of 75 - 100 words summarizing your discussion.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I discuss ethical doctrines.

☐ ☐

I give my opinion on an ethical dilemma.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph describing solutions to an ethical dilemma.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **conscience** (noun): the inner sense of what is right or wrong
e.g. How humans came to develop a conscience has been a subject of debate and research at least since Darwin's Origin of Species was published in 1859.
- **judgment** (noun): the ability to judge or make decisions
e.g. We will choose our own path according to our personal judgment.
- **imperfect** (adjective): not perfect; faulty in some way
e.g. You are confronted with two imperfect choices, but you will only be able to choose one.
- **utilitarianism** (noun): an ethical doctrine based on utility
e.g. One technique to use when thinking about a problem is to approach it through utilitarianism.
- **deontology** (noun): a form of ethics dealing with moral obligation and right action
e.g. You can approach an ethical dilemma through deontology.
- **inherently** (adjective): existing within or describing something by its nature
e.g. In deontology, actions are either inherently right or wrong.





Learning Points

Negatives with Must and Have to

The negatives of **must** and **have to** have somewhat different meanings than their affirmative counterparts. Let's look at the differences in meanings:

Don't have to

When you want to talk about a situation in which you have the freedom to choose to do something, you use **don't have to**. There is no obligation, you are free to act as you will.

For example:

*You **don't have to** attend the company Christmas party. (You can choose to go or not to go.)*

Must not

When you want to talk about something that is prohibited (strictly forbidden or unacceptable), you use **must not**.

For example:

*Passengers **must not** bring liquids onto the plane.*

*You **mustn't** enter a contract without reading it first.*

Examples:

- *Your conscience is the voice saying you **mustn't** do this, you cannot think that or you may not go there.*
- *In deontology, actions are either inherently right or wrong. Individuals **must** distinguish between them.*
- *We **don't have to** decide on the "right" theory for every situation, but it is interesting to see what insight each perspective has to offer.*





Learning Points

Will and Would for Willingness and Intention

When you want to express intention to do something or a willingness to do something, you can use the modal verbs **will** and **would**.

You can use **will** to talk about someone's willingness in the present moment to do something.

You can use **won't** to talk about someone's UNwillingness in the present moment to do something.

When talking about the past, you can use **would** to express that someone was generally willing to do things.

You can use **wouldn't** to talk about UNwillingness in the past in both single situations and generally.

Context is particularly important to understand the exact meaning of each verb.

For example:

*Joanna **will** translate for you - she speaks Japanese. (willingness)*

I'll do it - I don't mind. (willingness)

*The workers **won't** vote for me. (willingness)*

*I **won't** be coming later. (intention)*

***Would** you mind helping me, please? (willingness)*

I'll call you later. (intention)

Examples:

- *We will choose our own path according to our personal judgment.*
- *As a follower of deontology, you would assess whether the value of a particular action is less than the consequences of that action.*
- *If you are a utilitarian, you will prioritize the consequences over the actions themselves.*

